

Regular Meeting
Monday, September 9, 2019
Medford School Committee
Medford High School

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson, Assistant Superintendent Peter Cushing.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Meeting called to order at 7:02pm.

Approval of Minutes of June 24, 2019 - Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Ms. DiBenedetto - Unclassified National Grid? Ms. Patterson - Revolving account. Ms. DiBenedetto - Richard Trotta dues? Ms. Patterson - Mr. Trotta attended the Massachusetts Association of School Superintendents conference to present on CCSR. Ms. DiBenedetto - Pending classification? Ms. Patterson - Trust fund based on use. Ms. DiBenedetto - JJ Ruddy. Ms. Patterson - Insurance. Ms. Van der Kloot - There is a typo on page 10 Greater Boston League, so it does not cause a problem down the line. Ms. Patterson - I will let the vendor know.

Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Report of the Superintendent - Dr. Edouard-Vincent introduced the new administrators who were hired recently: Peter Cushing, Joan Bowen, Julia MacEwan, Lisa Kingsley, Alice Beth Fitzpatrick, Maureen Lavin, Lisa Ianelli, and Lauren Parillo.

Diane Caldwell - We are lucky to have partnerships with various corporations and companies in Medford. Sam Tarabelsi, Sue Sandberg, Janet Piroult, Stephanie Altavista from W.B. Mason, Davon Fores from Armstrong Ambulance. The beginning of the school year is always difficult for some of our families, having backpacks full of school supplies available is a great relief.

Sam Tarabelsi - Thank you Diane, I have been doing this for 12 years and it is a pleasure. W.B. Mason, Armstrong Ambulance, Team Medford, and Medford Kiwanis. Our CEO Sue Sandberg took the time to be here and it means a lot to us, we are doing the right thing for our community and our school system.

Sue Sandberg - We are happy to be a part of this community and support our children. Wishing you all an awesome school year. Mayor Burke - Thank you to Team Medford for your work.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - When I mentioned the extreme generosity, in addition to what Team Medford presented, we also received a generous donation from Wegmans of 200 backpacks filled with school supplies. Agero also donated an additional 200 backpacks with school supplies. As we present additional reports to you this evening, you will hear from our partners and how we say thank you, to Joseph Transportation and others.

This summer we had our 6th grade welcome barbecue and the summer graduation. Thank you to all who supported those new events. Thank you to Wegmans for providing all the water and sports drinks for that evening. We had a collaborative effort of both PTOs at the middle schools. Our high school summer graduation, thank you for supporting that event. The students who graduated are true Mustangs and Mustangs never give up. Today we had another first in our district: we had middle school sports try-outs.

One of our students who graduated in 2017, Joseph Farrah, a physics major at the honors college of UMass Boston is sharing in a \$3 million breakthrough prize for being part of the Event Horizon Telescope that took the first image of a black hole. When the image was recorded, Farrah was the only undergraduate on the 347 member team.

I am looking forward to another great year, as always, go Mustangs.

Mayor Burke - Please send a thank you letter to all the groups you mentioned. Ms. DiBenedetto - Can Joseph Farrah come back for a commendation or presentation to show all of Medford how proud we are of our students? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes. Mr. Ruggiero - It would be great to get a presentation on the black hole photographs to our middle school students. Dr. Edouard-Vincent showed a video of the first day of school this year.

Recommendation to Approve Donation from Impact Church - Nicholas Tucci - Impact Church has generously offered to donate a Chromebook cart to the McGlynn Middle School. We thank Impact Church for their support of the McGlynn Middle School. I would like to introduce Crystal Erb the Impact Church youth director. Ms. Erb - We thank you for the opportunity to give to your community. Mayor Burke - We appreciate the partnership. Mr. Tucci - We also thank Impact Church for a welcome back luncheon.

Motion to accept the donation offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative
Motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Liquor Permit for M3 Outdoor Adventures Oktoberfells Race - Niklas Tower - Our mission is to get kids outside. M3OA was founded in 2019 to link students in the greater Boston area with the outside world to encourage a lifetime of stewardship and appreciation for the outdoors. Students and M3OA staff will be hosting the Oktoberfells 5K race and festival. With your support this race will be a great stride forward for kids getting outdoors. Mayor Burke - Mr. Tower also organizes the canoe race at Wright's Pond. Mr. Tower - Kevin Bailey is also a great supporter and partner with us. The food will be provided by Red Bones and the beer will be provided by Medford Brewing Company.

Motion to accept offered by Ms. Kreatz. Ms. DiBenedetto - What time of day is your event? Mr. Tower - It starts at 11AM and ends by 4PM. Ms. DiBenedetto - How much indoor access do you get? Mr. Tower - No indoor access. We use port-o-potties. Community Schools helps us with tables and chairs. I am in touch with the custodians. Clean up is done by our group. We hire a police detail, we have staff surrounding and checking IDs. It is very official. Ms. DiBenedetto - Do they apply through Community Schools? Who is the responsible person? Any time we donate any part of our schools, we need to know who to follow up with. Do we rent that facility to a church on Sundays? Dr. Edoaurd-Vincent - The church uses the front. Mr. Tower - Parking has not been a problem in the past. Ms. DiBenedetto - Is the church group notified? Dr. Edoaurd-Vincent - Yes. Ms. Van der Kloot - Is there a walking option? Mr. Tower - We have a family fun run 1K, and we have worked to limit the environmental impact of the course.

Motion to approve offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative
0 - Negative
Motion passes.

Ms. DiBenedetto - The School Committee should do a canoe for the race next year. Mr. Tower - I recommend you work with the Vocational School to have them build a canoe.

Report on Administrative Meetings - Ms. Caldwell - New administrators were hired. The Superintendent welcomed back our administrators and outlined her plans and expectations. We had a busy and productive summer. Ms. DiBenedetto - How are our administrators evaluated? Ms. Caldwell - All of our administrators are evaluated. It is divvied up between Dr. Vincent, myself, and others. It is similar to teachers, we have formative and summative evaluations, but the rubric is different. Ms. DiBenedetto - The Superintendent evaluates top administrators? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes. Ms. DiBenedetto - I want to make sure it is done equitably across the

district. Ms. DiBenedetto - Can parents join the dyslexia committee? Ms. Caldwell - Suzannah Campbell is chairing the committee, parents may contact her. Ms. DiBenedetto - Can you do an update to us about the dyslexia training after it takes place? Ms. Caldwell - Yes. Ms. DiBenedetto - Did we purchase the dyslexia program for Kindergarteners yet? Ms. Caldwell - Not yet. We wrote a grant and we are piloting MAPS Growth at the Columbus Elementary School. Ms. DiBenedetto - I thought we were evaluating Kindergarteners this year. That did not happen? Ms. Caldwell - I have to look through my notes on that. The Department of Education is unclear on their standards. Ms. DiBenedetto - My memory is that we were moving forward with evaluating Kindergarteners this year. Please put it on the agenda for next time and I will speak with the Superintendent. I also have concerns about the math program. Do they have the colored paper they need? Are the manipulatives available to all students? I request we put this on the agenda. Ms. Caldwell - Ms. Khan is planning to be here next time to discuss Illustrative Math.

Ms. Van der Kloot - I was also under the impression that we were not piloting a program but that the will of the School Committee was to be very aggressive with evaluating for dyslexia. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - There was a debate about which program, and the timing and the training it would require. We were awarded the grant for one school only, a different program, so we have not begun implementing the dyslexia program yet, we will pull up those records and get them for next meeting, what were next steps. Ms. Van der Kloot - I request a report about the breakfast program. Mr. Ruggiero - Do we know when the DESE guidelines will come out? Ms. Caldwell - The fall of next year. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We were chosen as a pilot district, based on the pilot districts and what the data yielded, DESE will provide guidance. Mr. Ruggiero - Can we have someone from DESE come in and speak with us about what they have planned? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I can reach out to them.

Ms. DiBenedetto - We felt as a Committee that it was too important to wait for DESE to make their decision. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes, my recollection was that it was going to be screening in early fall, around the end of the first term. I will gather that information and bring it to you.

Motion to approve the report and place on file offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Report on Teacher Induction Week - Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli - We wanted to welcome new teachers to Medford and help them see us as a caring educational partnership of school, family, and community. Teachers participated in workshops and activities and by the end of the week they were much more relaxed and eager to begin their work. We added a tour of Medford, which was very popular, and special thanks to Lisa Evangelista for implementing it and to Nick Tucci for the idea. Lisa has a wonderful knowledge of Medford history and she narrated the tour.

Thank you to Dominic Camarra for the ice cream at Colleen's, Rocco DiRico at Tufts, Joseph Albano of Joseph's Transportation, and LaCascia's Bakery.

Motion to receive this report and place on file offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Report on Buildings and Grounds Summer Updates - John McLaughlin, the Director of Buildings and Grounds reviewed all the major projects that were taken on over the summer, including curbing and compressors at multiple schools. Mr. McLaughlin - We are moving forward with refinishing floors in the theater at the high school, and the replacement of the chairs is delayed because of a 16 week lead time on upholstery. We are grateful that the city sees the value of maintenance. The Medford Department of Public Works helps us a lot and we are very grateful to them. Mayor Burke - There are three applications in from the school department for CPA. Ms. Kreatz - I was comparing this report to the year 1 capital improvement plan. Did you do the Curtis Tufts front stairs? Mr. McLaughlin - The cost of the project is going to potentially be much higher than the funds allotted. We are going to get some more quotes and see if we can fit it for the next time. Ms. Kreatz - Is it dangerous? Mr. McLaughlin - No, it is functional, but not aesthetically pleasing. Ms. Kreatz - Are we not guaranteed free cash? Ms. Patterson - We are not guaranteed free cash. We were making a five year plan to go to City Council. That does not mean it would equate to funding. It was a request or wish list. We are not able to get free cash for all the projects until DOR certification. Mayor Burke - Once the books are closed on the municipality, they submit to DOR. Hopefully in October we will get an allotment of free cash and then we request amounts from City Council. Ms. Van der Kloot - When will the CPC happen? Ms. Patterson - The allocations come in the spring. Ms. Van der Kloot - We are not moving forward on playgrounds until the spring. Mayor Burke - Correct. Ms. Van der Kloot - Are we going to bond? Mayor Burke - When you get CPC funding you do not have to bond for as much. Ms. Van der Kloot - The Columbus playground needs to be resurfaced. If the money comes in the spring the projects will not happen until the summer. I am disappointed that we are not moving more aggressively on this. We should be thinking of a plan B now. Mayor Burke - Once we get approval we can move, and we can make a plan B if we do not get plan A. A playground resurface can happen quickly, over a week long school vacation.

Ms. DiBenedetto - Can we get all the rugs cleaned everywhere? Mr. McLaughlin - Yes. Ms. DiBenedetto - Can we continue the painting at the Curtis Tufts? Mr. McLaughlin - Yes. Ms. DiBenedetto - Can we use the funds that were allotted to the stairs at the Curtis Tufts for something else? Ms. Patterson - The funds were used for projects that were allotted for year 1. Ms. DiBenedetto - The Curtis Tufts is looking worn and it could use some banners and plantings, it welcomes people to Medford and it should stand out. Is the water seepage in the Columbus safe? Mr. McLaughlin - The space is not occupied but it is safe. Mr. Ruggiero - Inventory of

equipment was requested. Mr. McLaughlin - I sent the start of a list and was waiting to hear back. Mr. Ruggiero - I will look at it and get back to you.

Mr. Ruseau - Much of the equipment at the Columbus was removed because it was unsafe. Will it be replaced? Mr. McLaughlin - It would not make sense to put in a new surface at the Columbus without replacing the equipment. He is working on an estimate. Mayor Burke - This could be a topic for the Buildings and Grounds subcommittee.

Motion to receive this report and place it on file offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Report on Attendance - Ms. Caldwell delivered a report of attendance numbers. Ms. Van der Kloot - Do we have any students here for medical reasons who may be adversely affected by the federal regulations around immigration status? Ms. Caldwell - Not that we know of. Ms. Van der Kloot - If they come to you can you tell us so we can advocate for them? Ms. Caldwell - Yes.

Mr. Ruseau - Can you get numbers of charter schools enrollment? Ms. Caldwell - I can look into that. Ms. Patterson - The charter enrollment is not available until June from DESE. We are working on trying to win back some of our students and trying to track which charter school students are actually Medford residents. Mr. Ruseau - It would be helpful to see when we can. Ms. Kreatz - I have heard there is an increased class size in the Vocational School numbers. This number is combined. Can we see a breakdown in an updated report? Ms. Mustone - 10th grade: 150 CTE, 170 General, 9th grade 207 CTE, 122 General.

Ms. DiBenedetto - Can we also look at private and parochial schools? Mr. Ruseau - What is the MCAS issue? Ms. DiBenedetto - Students are not required to take MCAS if they go to private or parochial schools. Ms. Caldwell - We do have that information. Dr. Ricciardelli - Each February we are required to report this, so I have these numbers.

Motion to receive this report and place on file offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Report on Personnel - Kirsteen Patterson - We have rolled out a new platform that completely automates our process for posting. Everything is electronic and we have demographic information as well as the ability to post ongoing positions. This summer we have been rolling out the new system. The new program gives us a better idea of our applicant pool. We are committed to diversity and hiring a diverse staff, this will make that a more streamlined process. Mr. Ruseau - When I go to Shore Collaborative they give a personnel report each time. Can this system do that reporting? Ms. Patterson - This system is only for new hires. We do not have the

capability of automatically reporting retirements, leaves of absence, etc. It will still be a manual report.

Motion to receive and place this report on file offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Report on Summer Programs - Dr. Peter Cushing - Anthony Petrelis submitted a report on Summer Fun. We had a few heat issues and came in and visited the fields to make sure it was bearable, some people brought in their own air conditioners. We had special visits from Marian Ryan and Mayor Burke. The camp made effective use of its Facebook page. A report on Summer School was sent by David Blauch. Students used PLATO for coursework to great effect. A report on Extended School Year was given by Lisa Ianelli, where 136 students were slated to receive services, though 19 did not attend despite outreach and planning. Ms. DiBenedetto - Last year we worked to make sure the staff at Summer Fun was trained to meet the needs of students. Did the price increase effect enrollment? Did we provide more families with vouchers or scholarships? Please get back to us.

Motion to accept this report and place on file offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Report on Middle School Lottery Implementation - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - A recap was given on the reasons the middle school lottery was needed, the demographic breakdowns were reviewed prior to the lottery. The slide deck showed the improvement in demographic distribution of the new 6th grade class. The lottery has been a success and in the coming years the breakdowns will continue to improve the numbers in all grades. Thank you for trusting us and for your support with this endeavor. We continue to look for opportunities for both schools to work more collaboratively. Ms. Kreatz - Why are students in a language program not in the lottery? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Students are assigned to a school based on their IEP. There may be a program with a similar name but the special education team looks at each student individually. We do not have identical programs in each school because of the significant human capital required. Cheryl Rodriguez - 281 Park Street - Roberts Elementary School students were not evenly split. EL students were not integrated into the school. Each of the elementary schools should have five children to balance. My daughter has been isolated at the McGlynn. I hope the social emotional health of students will be factored in next year. Melanie McLaughlin - 152 Allston Street - I thank you for looking at the equity imbalance. As the co-chair of SEPAC, I am concerned about equity across the district and what those visuals would look like in EL and special education. I would suggest that we think outside the box for EL and special education students since the two schools are very close. I hope we will look in the future at the elementary schools as well. Can we do a visual for special education and EL? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The McGlynn houses the

EL students. The Andrews houses the TLP program. You could have a higher number of students with disabilities at one school but it is due to the distribution of programs.

Motion to receive this report and place it on file offered by Ms Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

New Business

Selection of Delegates to MASC Fall Conference. Ms Van der Kloot nominated Paul Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

7 - Paul Ruseau

Mr. Ruseau would like to nominate Ms. Van der Kloot as a back-up, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Roll call vote

7 - Paulette Van der Kloot

Motion to cancel the November 4th meeting offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Summer condolences were read by Mayor Burke.

Motion to adjourn offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes. Meeting adjourned at 9:14pm.